

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1965-07-22

To the National Spiritual Assembly of the United S

25.1 GRIEVE ANNOUNCE PASSING OUTSTANDING HAND CAUSE LEROY IOAS. HIS LONG

SERVICE BAHÁ'Í COMMUNITY UNITED STATES CROWNED ELEVATION RANK HAND

FAITH PAVING WAY HISTORIC DISTINGUISHED SERVICES HOLY LAND. APPOINTMENT

FIRST SECRETARY GENERAL INTERNATIONAL BAHÁ'Í COUNCIL PERSONAL

REPRESENTATIVE GUARDIAN FAITH TWO INTERCONTINENTAL CONFERENCES

48ASSOCIATION HIS NAME BY BELOVED GUARDIAN OCTAGON DOOR BÁB'S SHRINE

TRIBUTE SUPERVISORY WORK DRUM DOME THAT HOLY SEPULCHRE NOTABLE PART

ERECTION INTERNATIONAL ARCHIVES BUILDING ALL ENSURE HIS NAME IMMORTAL

ANNALS FAITH. LAID TO REST BAHÁ'Í CEMETERY CLOSE FELLOW HANDS ADVISE HOLD

BEFITTING MEMORIAL SERVICES. ...

THEUNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

26 Purification of the Most Holy Shrine of Bahá'u'lláh, the Qiblih of the Bahá'í World

11 N OVEMBER 1965

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

26.1 ANNOUNCE BAHÁ'Í WORLD REMOVAL FROM IMMEDIATE PRECINCTS HOLY SHRINE

BAHÁ'U'LLÁH REMAINS MÍRZÁ DÍYÁ'U'LLÁH YOUNGER BROTHER MÍRZÁ MU ḤAMMAD-

'ALÍ HIS ACCOMPLICE IN EFFORTS SUBVERT FOUNDATIONS COVENANT GOD SOON

AFTER ASCENSION BAHÁ'U'LLÁH. THIS FINAL STEP IN PROCESS PURIFICATION SACRED INTERNATIONAL ENDOWMENTS FAITH IN BAHJÍ FROM PAST CONTAMINATION WAS

PROVIDENTIALLY UNDERTAKEN UPON REQUEST FAMILY OLD
COVENANT-BREAKERS A

PROCESS WHOSE INITIAL STAGE WAS FULFILLED BY 'ABDU'L-BAHÁ WHICH
GATHERED

MOMENTUM EARLY YEARS BELOVED GUARDIAN'S MINISTRY THROUGH
EVACUATION

MANSION ATTAINED CLIMAX THROUGH PURIFICATION ḤARAM-I-AQDAS AND
NOW

CONSUMMATED THROUGH CLEANSING INNER SANCTUARY MOST HALLOWED
SHRINE

QIBLIH BAHÁ'Í WORLD PRESAGING EVENTUAL CONSTRUCTION BEFITTING

MAUSOLEUM AS ANTICIPATED BELOVED SIGN GOD ON EARTH.

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

27 Reasons for Delay in Translating and Publishing the Kitáb-i-Aqdas

6 DECEMBER 1965

The National Spiritual Assembly of the Bahá'ís of the United States Dear Bahá'í Friends, 27.1
We have received a number of inquiries as to the translation and publication of the Kitáb-i-Aqdas from friends who are unable to read it in its original form. We feel the following extract from a letter written on behalf of the beloved Guardian by his secretary dated 27 December 1941, addressed to the National Spiritual Assembly of India and Burma clarifies this question: 4927.1a The reason it [the Kitáb-i-Aqdas] is not circulated amongst all the Bahá'ís is, first, because the Cause is not yet ready or sufficiently matured to put all the provisions of the Aqdas into effect and, second, because it is a book which requires to be supplemented by detailed explanations and to be translated into other languages by a competent body of experts. The provisions of the Aqdas are gradually, according to the progress of the Cause, being put into effect already, both in the East and the West. ...

27.2 As is well known, the beloved Guardian has already given in God Passes By, pp. 214–15, a summary of the contents of this Most Holy Book, and included the codification of all the laws of the Kitáb-i-Aqdas as one of the objectives of the Ten Year Crusade. It is the intention of the Universal House of Justice to achieve this objective by publishing a synopsis and codification of these laws during the current Nine Year Plan.

27.3 Much of the Kitáb-i-Aqdas has already been translated by the beloved Guardian and has been given to the friends in the West, although not designated, in every case, as coming from the Most Holy Book. We give you below a list of such references for your guidance:

Gleanings from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh Sections XXXVII, LVI, LXX, LXXI,

LXXII, XCVIII, CV, CLV, CLIX,

and CLXV The Promised Day is Come pp. 26 (1st para.), 36–37 (until the end of 2nd para.), 40 (2nd para.), and 84–85 (until the end of 1st para.) The Challenging Requirements of the Present Hour pp. 16–17 (until the end of 1st para.) Bahá'í Administration p. 21 (1st para.) The World Order of Bahá'u'lláh p. 134 (2nd para.) The Bahá'í Community (1963 edition) p. 4 (2nd & 3rd paras.) Star of the West, Vol. XIV pp. 112–14 27.4 The two reasons given by the Guardian in the extract of the letter quoted above need further amplification:

27.4a 1. As regards the first reason, regarding the timeliness of putting into effect all the provisions of the Kitáb-i-Aqdas, it must be borne in mind that the beloved Guardian further stated:

... the Laws revealed by Bahá'u'lláh in the Aqdas are, whenever practicable and not in direct conflict with the Civil Law of the land, absolutely binding on every believer or 50Bahá'í institution whether in the East or in the West. Certain laws, such as fasting, obligatory prayers, the consent of the parents before marriage, avoidance of alcoholic drinks, monogamy, should be regarded by all believers as universally and vitally applicable at the present time. Others have been formulated in anticipation of a state of society destined to emerge from the chaotic conditions that prevail today. When the Aqdas is published this matter will be further explained and elucidated. What has not been formulated in the Aqdas, in addition to matters of detail and of secondary importance arising out of the application of the Laws already formulated by

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]